

Winning Proposal Template

Copy this structure for every quote. It sells the outcome first, presents price as a choice between options (not yes/no), and closes with a clear expiry. Replace everything in [brackets].

Proposal: [Project Name]

Prepared for: [Client name, Company] **Prepared by:** [Your name] **Date:** [Date] · **Valid until:** [Date +14 days]

1. What You Told Me

[2–4 sentences reflecting their situation back, using their exact words from the discovery call. This section does more selling than any other — it proves you listened.]

Example: “You’re getting consistent traffic to the site, but only 0.8% of visitors book a call. You’ve tried two redesigns that focused on visuals rather than conversion, and every month this continues costs you an estimated 15–20 qualified leads.”

2. What Success Looks Like

By the end of this project, you will have:

- [Outcome 1 — in business terms, not deliverable terms]
- [Outcome 2]
- [Outcome 3]

(Write “a checkout flow that converts above 2%”, not “5 redesigned pages.”)

3. How We’ll Get There

Phase	What happens	You’ll receive	Timing
1. [Discovery/Audit]	[1 sentence]	[Deliverable]	Week 1
2. [Build/Create]	[1 sentence]	[Deliverable]	Weeks 2–3
3. [Refine/Launch]	[1 sentence]	[Deliverable]	Week 4

4. Investment

Option A — [Core]: \$[X] [Everything in Section 3. The complete solution to the problem discussed.]

Option B — [Core + Growth]: \$[Y, roughly 1.6–2x of A] Everything in Option A, plus: - [High-value addition, e.g., 60 days of post-launch optimization] - [Second addition]

Most clients in your situation choose Option B, because [specific reason tied to their goal].

Payment terms: [40%] to begin, [30%] at [milestone], [30%] on delivery. Payable within [7] days of invoice.

5. What's Included — and What's Not

Included: [revision rounds, e.g., “two rounds of revisions per deliverable”], project management, weekly written status updates.

Not included (available at \$[rate]/hr): [common scope-creep items for your field — extra revision rounds, additional pages, new formats, rush turnaround].

6. About Me

[3–4 sentences: who you help, one relevant result with a number, one line of social proof.]

“[Short client testimonial with a concrete result.]” — [Name, Company]

7. Next Step

To start, reply “Option A” or “Option B” to this email. I'll send the agreement and deposit invoice the same day, and we'll have your kickoff call within [3] business days.

This proposal is valid until **[date]**. My next available start date after that is [date +3–4 weeks].

Why Each Piece Is There (delete before sending)

- **“What You Told Me” comes first** because clients skim proposals looking for evidence you understood them. Price means nothing until they trust the diagnosis.
- **Two options, not one** changes the question from “yes or no?” to “which one?” — and 30–40% of clients take the bigger option when it's framed around their goal.
- **The expiry date and next start date are real scarcity**, not fake urgency — your calendar genuinely fills. State it plainly and it motivates a decision without pressure tactics.
- **“Not included” is your anti-scope-creep insurance.** Naming the extras up front makes billing for them later a smooth conversation instead of a conflict.

Part of The Freelance Client Kit. Single-user commercial license.